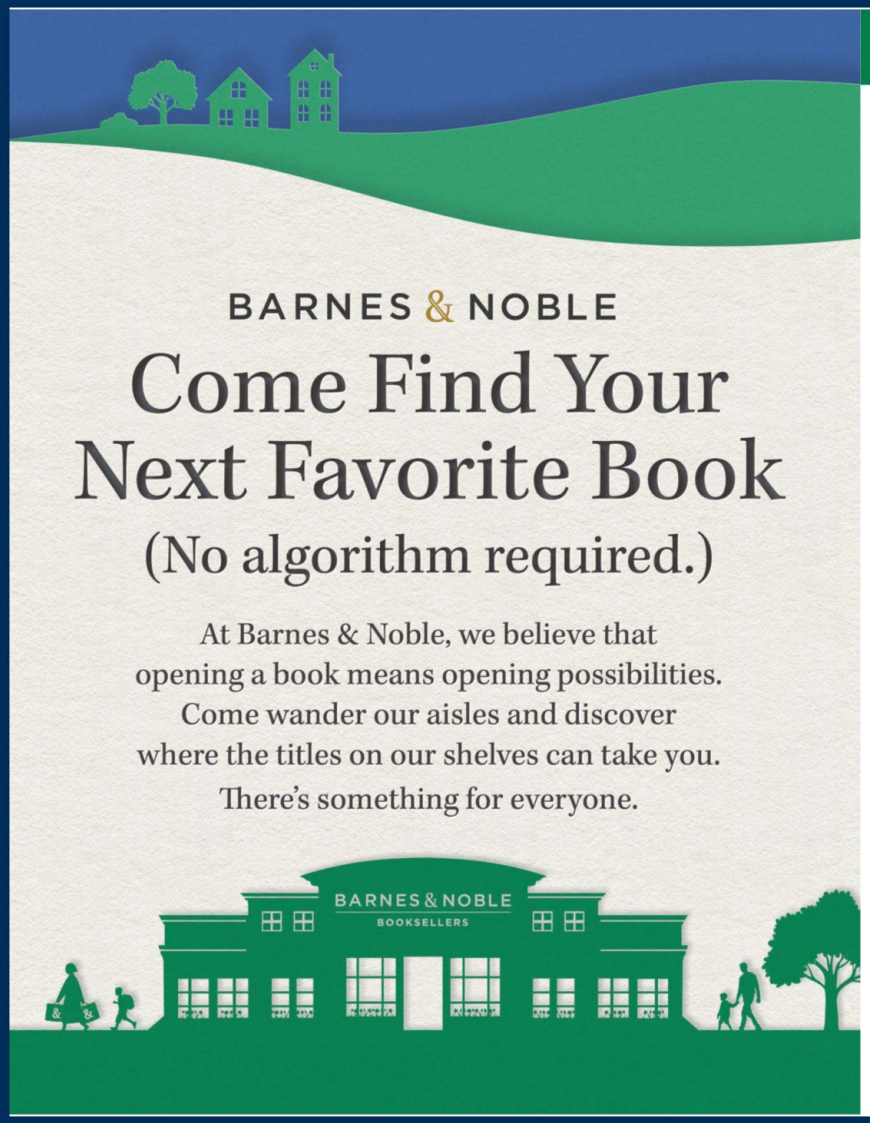


INDEPENDENT

1. Notre Dame - HC Marcus Freeman enters Year No. 5. In his first 3 years they were 9-4, 10-3 then went 11-1 then won playoff games over Indiana, Georgia and Penn St, coming up short in the National Title game. Last year the big question was inexperience at QB but CJ Carr answered that throwing for 2,741 (66%, 24-6). For the second straight year, they had a tough road test to open, this time at Miami and dropped that as they gave up a last-second TD and then lost to Texas A&M at home. The Irish pretty much throttled the rest of their competition and were firmly in the weekly playoff rankings, until the last one where they were left out! Notre Dame turned down a bowl and their motto this year is "Leave No Doubt". They have the best defense in the country and should find solid replacements for the two #1 DC RB's they lost. They are #4 in my experience chart Notre Dame is my pick to win the National Title this year.

2. Connecticut - The Huskies did not play in '20 & were just 7-41 the previous 5Y with the losses by an avg 26.2 ppg. HC Jim Mora shocked me by getting them to a bowl in his first year! They were -77 ypg and had 3 Net Upsets, both signs pointing down for 2023 and the magic faded in a 3-9 season. In '24 they routed North Carolina in the bowl for a 9-4 finish. Last year my power ratings had them anywhere from 7-10 wins and they went 9-3 with all 3 losses in OT! Connecticut and Indiana were the only two teams last year, that did not lose a regular season game in regulation. Mora left for Colorado St and took a bunch of players with him. Jason Candle comes over from Toledo. He is an excellent recruiter and restocked the shelves as best he could, but they do look a little weaker in 2026. The Schedule is also tougher, so they will not match last year win total as this looks like more of a rebuilding year.

PHIL'S 2025 IND RANKING

	QB	RB	REC	OL	DL	LB	DB	ST	CH
Notre Dame	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Connecticut	2	2	1	2	2	2	2	2	2

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2025 INDEPENDENT vs P5 OFFENSIVE TEAM STATS

PS 25 Rank		FBS PPG	PPG Rank	FBS Off	Total Rank	FBS Rush	Rush Rank	FBS YPC	YPC Rank	FBS Pass	Pass Rank	FBS %	% Rank	FBS YPP	YPP Rank	Off TD	TD Rank	Sks Vs	Sks Rank	PS 25 Rank		FBS PPG	PPG Rank	FBS Def	Total Rank	FBS Rush	Rush Rank	FBS YPC	YPC Rank	FBS Pass	Pass Rank	FBS %	% Rank	FBS YPP	YPP Rank	Def TD	TD Rank	Sks By	Sks Rank
1	Notre Dame	42.0	1	459	1	203	1	5.7	1	255	2	67.2	2	10	2	10	2	12	1	3	Notre Dame	17.6	1	313	1	99	1	3.0	1	213	1	55.7	1	17.8	1	23	1	35	2
36	Connecticut	33.3	2	429	2	153	2	4.9	2	276	1	67.7	1	12	1	1	2	15	2	100	Connecticut	28.2	2	431	2	206	2	4.9	2	226	2	67.0	2	15.3	2	17	2	36	1

2025 INDEPENDENT vs P5 DEFENSIVE TEAM STATS

RUSHING YPG

	Ypg	Att	Net	Ypc	Td's
Jeremiyah Love , Notre Dame	114.3	199	1372	6.9	18
Cam Edwards, UConn	95.4	210	1240	5.9	15
Jadarian Price, Notre Dame	56.2	113	674	6.0	11
Aneyas Williams, Notre Dame	**18.7**	**24**	**224**	**9.3**	**5**
Kenny Minchey, Notre Dame	14.0	7	84	12.0	1
Oliver Lundberg Coleman, UConn	12.5	23	138	6.0	1
Victor Rosa, UConn	11.9	30	155	5.2	2
Joe Fagnano, UConn	10.9	47	131	2.8	3
Terrence Smith, UConn	5.8	14	75	5.4	1
Gi'Bran Payne, Notre Dame	4.4	9	53	5.9	0
CJ Carr, Notre Dame	**2.8**	**41**	**33**	**0.8**	**3**

RECEIVING YPG

	Ypg	Rec	Yds	Ypc	Td's
Skyler Bell, UConn	98.3	101	1278	12.7	13
Jordan Faison, Notre Dame	**53.3**	**49**	**640**	**13.1**	**4**
Malachi Fields, Notre Dame	52.5	36	630	17.5	5
Eli Raridon, Notre Dame	40.2	32	482	15.1	0
Reymello Murphy, UConn	35.0	40	455	11.4	3
John Neider, UConn	32.5	27	422	15.6	2
Will Pauling, Notre Dame	31.8	26	381	14.7	6
Juice Vereen, UConn	31.0	22	310	14.1	5
Jeremiyah Love, Notre Dame	23.3	27	280	10.4	3
Shamar Porter, UConn	**18.0**	**18**	**234**	**13.0**	**1**
Louis Hansen, UConn	14.9	20	194	9.7	0
Cam Edwards, UConn	14.4	19	187	9.8	1
Alex Honig, UConn	13.5	13	162	12.5	3
Victor Rosa, UConn	11.3	15	147	9.8	1

KICKING w/ TEAM GRADE

	Grade	FG#/FGA	Lg
Chris Freeman, UConn	4.28	23-26	50
Noah Burnette, Notre Dame	1.56	5-6	48

TEAM NET P & Ply'r Gross

	Tm Net	Punts	Avg
James Randell, Notre Dame	43.3	25	44.6
Connor Stutz, UConn	40.2(t)	48	45.9

PUNT RETURNS

	Avg	Att	Yds
Jackson Harper, UConn	8.3	18	150
Jordan Faison, Notre Dame	**6.0**	**23**	**138**

PASS EFFICIENCY

	Qbr	Comp	Att	%	Yards	Ypg	Td	Int
CJ Carr, Notre Dame	**168.1**	**195**	**293**	**66.6**	**2741**	**228.4**	**24**	**6**
Joe Fagnano, UConn	161.0	285	413	69	3448	287.3	28	1
Kenny Minchey, Notre Dame	140.2	20	26	76.9	196	32.7	0	0
Nick Evers, UConn	147.5	10	15	66.7	105	35.0	1	0
Ksaan Farrar, UConn	100.3	11	18	57.9	84	42.0	0	0

TACKLES PER GAME

	GM	Ti's
Bryun Parham, UConn	9.7	126
Oumar Diomande, UConn	8.9	116
Malachi McLean, UConn	7.9	79
Drayk Bowen, Notre Dame	**5.6**	**67**
Lee Molette, UConn	5.4	65
Cam Chadwick, UConn	5.2	67
Tae Johnson, Notre Dame	**4.8**	**48**
D'Mon Brinson, UConn	4.5	58
Adon Shuler, Notre Dame	**4.4**	**53**
Kyngstonn Viliamu-Asa, Notre Dame	**4.4**	**48**
Jaiden Ausberry, Notre Dame	**4.3**	**51**

PBU's

	PBu's
Christian Gray, Notre Dame	**11**
Leonard Moore, Notre Dame	**7**
Trent Jones, UConn	6
D'Mon Brinson, UConn	6
Adon Shuler, Notre Dame	**5**
Tyrece Mills, UConn	5
Drayk Bowen, Notre Dame	**4**
Devin Pringle, UConn	4
Cam Chadwick, UConn	4
Bryce Young, Notre Dame	**3**
Lee Molette, UConn	3
DeVonta Smith , Notre Dame	3

TFL's

	TFL's
Bryun Parham, UConn	15.5
Boubacar Traore , Notre Dame	**10.0**
Oumar Diomande, UConn	8.0
Kyngstonn Viliamu-Asa, Notre Dame	**7.5**
Joshua Burnham , Notre Dame	6.0
D'Mon Brinson, UConn	5.5
Jaylen Sneed, Notre Dame	**5.0**
Donovan Branch, UConn	5.0
Aaron Key, UConn	5.0
Drayk Bowen, Notre Dame	**4.5**
Cleto Chol, UConn	4.5
Jaiden Ausberry, Notre Dame	**4.0**
Devin Pringle, UConn	4.0

SACKS

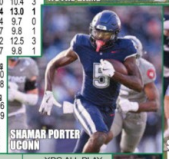
	Sks
Bryun Parham, UConn	10.5
Boubacar Traore , Notre Dame	**6.5**
Oumar Diomande, UConn	5
Cleto Chol, UConn	4.0
Donovan Branch, UConn	3.5
Drayk Bowen, Notre Dame	**3.5**
Kyngstonn Viliamu-Asa, Notre Dame	**3.0**
Joshua Burnham , Notre Dame	3
Jaylen Sneed, Notre Dame	**3**
Tyquan King, UConn	3
Amir Renwick, UConn	2.5
Jaiden Ausberry, Notre Dame	**2**
Marquis Black, UConn	2
Antoineo Harris, UConn	2
Modden Faraimo, Notre Dame	**2**
Bryce Young, Notre Dame	**2**
Brandon Kelly, UConn	1.5
Jason Onye , Notre Dame	**1.5**

INTERCEPTIONS

	Int's
Leonard Moore, Notre Dame	**5**
Cam Chadwick, UConn	4
Tae Johnson, Notre Dame	**4**
Luke Talich, Notre Dame	**3**
Adon Shuler, Notre Dame	**2**
Christian Gray, Notre Dame	**2**











2025

	W-L	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY
Notre Dame	10-2	504	211	6-1	4-1
Connecticut	9-4	459	351	6-0	3-3

2024

	W-L	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY
Notre Dame	14-2	578	248	7-2	7-0
Connecticut	9-4	415	300	6-1	3-3
Washington St	8-5	476	388	5-2	3-3
Oregon St	5-7	291	359	4-3	1-4
Massachusetts	2-10	270	426	2-4	0-6

2023

	W-L	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY
Notre Dame	10-3	509	207	5-1	3-2
Army	6-6	246	253	3-3	1-3
Connecticut	3-9	229	358	1-5	2-4
Massachusetts	3-9	278	454	1-5	2-4

ALL GAMES

YPG ALL PLAY

	2025	2024	2023
Notre Dame	145.8	91.6	155.9
Connecticut	27.2	(29.3)	(79.6)

ALL GAMES

YPG ALL PLAY

	2024	2023	2022
Notre Dame	+91.6	+155.9	+66.8
Connecticut	(29.3)	(79.6)	(77.2)
Washington St	(95.0)	(14.2)	(40.1)
Oregon St	(72.3)	+46.9	+39.4
Massachusetts	0.0	(70.8)	(103.8)

ALL GAMES

YPG ALL PLAY

	2023	2022	2021
Notre Dame	+155.9	+66.8	+66.7
Army	(79.6)	+7.1	+46.5
Connecticut	(79.6)	(77.2)	(186.9)
Massachusetts	(70.8)	(103.8)	(184.7)



KICK RETURNS

	Avg	Att	Yds
Jadarian Price, Notre Dame	37.5	12	450
Terrence Smith, UConn	21.6	11	238
Mel Brown, UConn	20.1	14	281



NOTRE DAME FIGHTING IRISH


QB CJ CARR

POSITION OUTLOOK FOR 2026

QUARTERBACKS - Notre Dame's previous 3 QB's had all been transfers, who combined for 88 td passes with just 20 int's. Last year they returned Kenny Minchey (PS#18), who hit 3-3 in three games the last 2 years, and CJ Carr (PS#6, elbow inj). They also signed true frosh Blake Herbert (PS#23). CJ Carr not only won the job, he was one of the top QB's in the country, playing beyond expectations. Carr threw for 2,741 (67%, 24-6) and now as a Soph gives the Irish long term stability at this position. Minchey (20-26-196) hit the portal. Herbert will battle a pair of true Frosh in Noah Grubbs (PS#15) and Teddy Jarrard (PS#100) for the backup job. As long as Carr stays healthy, he will be a Heisman contender and now has experience.

RUNNING BACKS - In '24 the unit lost their top guy (1341, 6.4, #5DC). Jadarian Price (PS#17) was a year removed from an ACL and the unit had plenty of talent (5 VHT's). Price improved to 746 (6.2) but the star was Jeremiah Love (PS#5), who had 1,125 (6.9) plus 17 td. He had 6.9 ypc in the regular season but take away a 98 yd td run vs Indy and a banged up Love had just 2.8 ypc in the playoffs. True frosh Aneyas Williams (PS#16) finished with 219 (6.4) and Kedren Young (PS#13) had 116 (5.5). Last year I rated them as my #2 rated RB corps but might have sold them short. Love had a ND stadium record 228 vs USC, was a Heisman finalist rushing for 1,372 (7.1) and Price added 674 (6.0) and was a dangerous return man. Those two both left early for the NFL and were both #1 DC's (Love-ARZ, Price-SEA). They still have plenty of talent. They return Williams (224, **9.3!**), Young (short ydg RB), who missed '25 with injury and rFr Nolan James (PS#52). They also add two VHT True Frosh Jonaz Walton (PS#11) and Javian Osborne (PS#10). They may not match the Love/Price combo output but this is still my #20 RB Corps.

RECEIVERS - In '24 Jaden Greathouse (PS#23) with 6-128 vs Ohio St led with 592 (14.1). Last year they lost their #2 (490, 12.0) & #3 (421, 9.8, #5 DC) WR's. They added transfers Malachi Fields (24 st, 1417, 12.5 2Y Virg) and Will Pauling (23 st, 1244, 10.7 2Y Wisc). HC Marcus Freeman said it was the deepest WR corps he has had. TE Cooper Flanagan (5 st, 55, 138) missed the season with injury while Greathouse was banged up and played in just 4 games (2 st, 73, 18.3). Fields was #2 with 630 (17.5), TE Eli Rairdon was #3 (482, 15.8) and Will Pauling #4 (381, 14.7) and all 3 depart (Fields #3 DC NYG). The unit returns #1 Jordan Faison (640, 13.1) and get back Greathouse and Flanagan. The unit has 11 VHT's including Ohio St PS#8 and #13 transfers and remain a solid unit.

OFFENSIVE LINE - In '24 in noisy College Station for the opener ND lined up 5 OL with a combined 6 career starts but won. C Ashton Craig was OFY week 2, rFr LT Charles Jagusah missed 13 games and G Billy Schrauth missed 3. The unit still performed beyond it's years with 201 (5.7) rush with 15 sacks allowed in regular season (10 in playoffs). Last year they lost 2.5 starters then Jagusah missed the year. They were more experienced (54 car sts) and HC Freeman told me it was his best OLine top to bottom that he has had here. Ashton Craig was OFY after 6 starts and Schrauth after 7 but ND rushed for 203 (5.7) and allowed just 12 sacks (3.7%). This year they lose RT Aamil Wagner (12/28) and Schrauth (7/22, #5 DC TB). They get back Craig and Jagusay, so basically have 4 starters back and return 64 career starts making this my #1 rated OLine!

DEFENSIVE LINE - In '24 the Irish DLine went from one to 3 returning starters. They lost DE Jordan Botelho (12 st '23) early (3 st), then Boubacar Traore 2 games later. ND allowed 138 (3.8) rush (worst s/'19) but had 40 sacks (8.9%). Last year they lost 3 starters. With Botelho and Traore back, they basically returned two starters and also added two P4 transfers. They allowed just 99 (3.0) rush with 30 sacks. This year they lose 6 DL (27 st, 96 tkl, 7 sk). DE Traore (11 st, 37 tkl, 6.5 sk) is back along with DT Jason Onye (9 st, 26 tkl), who was granted a 6th year. They also add 3 transfers from Pitt, Oregon and Alabama (15 comb st LY) and they could be even stronger under new DL coach Charlie Partridge. This is my #5 rated DLine.

LINEBACKERS - In '24 ND held foes to 83 ypg below their season average (#8). Last year they lost their 1 tkl'r (#4 DC) and NB (8 st, 37 tkl, 2 tfl). They returned their #3, #5, #6 and #8 tacklers, added in Bama starter DeVonta Smith at NB and had nine LB rated PS#40 or better. ND held foes to 91 ypg below their average (#12). This year they lose Smith (5 st, #14 tklr) but return 5 of their top 6 so this is my #1 LB corps.

DEFENSIVE BACKS - Into '24 ND had finished #3, #8, #13, #19, #12, #21 and #30 the prior 7 years in my PDR. In '24 finished #4 (52%, 14-19!). Last year they lost a 1st Tm AA S (16 st, #2 tkl'r, 6 int, 10 pbu, #3 DC), and a #2 DC DB. They added a VT transfer and were more experienced overall finishing #3 (55.6%. 14-21) in our PDR. This year they lose a FS (5 st, #7 tklr) but with 7 of the top 8 back including 1st team AA CB Leonard Moore this is my #1 secondary! Coach Freeman says it is the deepest secondary he has ever fielded.

SPECIAL TEAMS - In '22 ND blocked 7 punts, the key to moving up to #7 in our STR. In '23 they lost their K, P and STC but still finished #29. In '24 they lost their 1st Tm IND K. ND hit just 10-20 FG before making 5-6 in playoffs. Australian P James Rendell avg 41.8 (40.2 net). ND had average return game finishing #35 in our STR. Last year with an injured K and they hit just 5-9 FG's. Erik Schmidt having 55 TB on 70 KO and P Rendell avg 44.6 (43.3 net!). Jadarian Price had 2 KR td (37.5 avg) as ND finished #45. This year they lose Price, their K & P but add Purdue's K (15-17) and another Aussie P and will be back near the top.

ST RANK L6Y:	
2025	#45
2024	#35
2023	#29
2022	#7
2021	#57
2020	#28

COACHES - Marcus Freeman was the DC at Cincy ('17-'20) and here in '21 before taking over as HC for the bowl in '21. He was also a 1st Tm AA LB at Ohio St in my 2008 magazine. He won the Dodd Trophy for National Coach of the Year in '24. Third year OC Mike Denbrock was LSU OC ('22-'23), Cincy OC ('17-'21) and an ass't here the 7 years prior. 2nd year DC Chris Ash was DC at Wisconsin, Arkansas and Ohio St (co) then HC at Rutgers (8-32) and spent '21-'24 as an NFL ass't. Marty Biagi is the 4th year as STC. He's been an STC at Ole Miss ('22), Purdue ('20-'21) and UNT ('17-'19).

ALSO ON ROSTER: TE Henry Garrity 6'4" 230 Jr   LB Tommy Powlus 6'1" 213 So.

2025 RECAP 10-2 - **MIA** 75/10 td :12 14-7 H 75/12/7:37 td, 21-7. ND 54/10 fg, 75/3 td 24-24 3:21, MI 46/10 fg 1:04. **A&M-** ND blk punt td. AM 86yd td 7-7. ND 75/7 td, 38/11 fg 24-14. AM 75/9 td, 47/7 (int) td 28-24 H. AM fg 9:06 34-34. ND 75/12 td 2:53 (xpng). AM 74/13 td :13 41-40. **PUR-** ND 35-23 H (231-286!). PU 35yds 2H. ND 3 td, miss fg open 2H 56-30 (535-369). **ARK-** ND 6 td 6 1H poss 42-13 H (470-207). AR sod 2x, int 3x 56-13. **BST-** ND snag 4 int's. ND 69/6 td 7-0 1q. BS 72/10 td 4:03. ND 75/9 td 14-7 H. ND 79/10 td, 52/2 (sod) td 28-7 7:54. **NCSt-** Carr 342 pass ND (sod 18, int ez 8) 10-7 H 26-0 2H (485-233). **USC-** Love 228 rush. ND 14-13 H, 21-16. SC 65 yd td pass 4:17 3q 23-21. ND 100 yd KR td, ND 50/7 (fum) td. SC int 8. **BC-** ND 12-7 H, 18-10 3q (3 miss fg). Love 94 yd td 25-10 (458-281). **Navy** qb Horvath dnp. 7-7 1q, ND 21-10 H. ND td 1st 4 2H poss 49-10 (502-228). **Pitt-** ND miss fg, 74/14 sod 1, 21-3 H (240-81), 37-9, PT 79/12 td :00. **SYR-** ND most pts s/'32. 21-0 2 IR td, blk punt td, 49-0 H, 70-0. SY 75/12 td :04. **STN-** ND 66/1, 61/11 td, fake pt td 21-10, 35-3 H (319-90), 49-13, ST 80/12 td bkdr cov 49-20.

PHIL'S FORECAST

OFFENSE - In '23 my computer called for ND to have 426 ypg and 36 ppg and they put up 432 ypg and 39 ppg. In '24 my computer called for 37.5 ppg and 449 ypg and they had 39.0 ppg and 419 ypg! Last year they lost their QB but had my #2 rated RB's and my #3 rated OLine plus the best WR corps Freeman has had here. My computer called for ND to have 454 ypg and they had 459! They scored 56 pts in B2B games for first time since 1996 (Lou Holtz). This year they have a returning veteran QB for the first time since 2020. They do lose a pair of #1 DC RB's and 3 other draft picks but could be even stronger in 2026.

DEFENSE - In '22 my computer called for the Irish to allow 19 ppg and 302 ypg and they allowed 21.8 ppg and 327 ypg! In '23 eight starters were back and my computer called for them to allow 291 ypg and they gave up 276 and just 15.9 ppg! In '24 9 starters were back. My computer called for them to allow 293 ypg and they allowed 295!! Last year My computer called for 16.6 ppg and they allowed 17.6! They could have the best defense in the country this year with 10 starters back as this defense is loaded with depth and talent at every level.

2026 - In 2024 the Irish had 9 starters back from a defense that held foes to 83 ypg below their season average (#8!). The schedule very manageable (#57). With their talent and schedule, three of my 9 sets of power ratings called for a 12-0 season and the others all called for 11-1. I had them #6 and called for a playoff berth for the Irish. ND opened with a solid road win at Texas A&M but then was upset by Northern Illinois at home. ND then ran the table with all wins by DD except for Louisville. They blasted Indiana at home in the Playoffs (led 27-3) then upset Georgia in the next round getting their first New Years Day bowl win since 1994 (31 years!). The Irish were without top DL Cross and lost top LT Knapp but got past Penn St to get to the title game. With those two out and RB Love banged up (6 att) they came up short vs Ohio State but finished #2 AP. ND had gone from #18AP to #14 to #2 and last year was year four for HC Freeman. ND lost their first two games then blew out the remaining 10 foes. They were in the playoffs but without playing dropped after the conf title games and were left out and ND decided not to go to a bowl. This year ND is one of the most veteran teams in the country with 17 returning starters (9 of top 10 tklrs D) and their motto is "Leave No Doubt" using the '25 playoff snub as motivation. They do lose a pair of #1 DC's at RB but that room remains strong and QB Carr had a fantastic Frosh year and now has experience. They have a Joe Moore contending OLine and perhaps the best defense in the country. All 9 sets of my power ratings are calling for 12-0 this year with the toughest test Miami at home on Nov 7th. ND has playoff experience and have a great shot at winning it all.

2026 PROJECTED STARTING LINEUP

OFFENSE (Jersey # in Blue)

QB 13 CJ CARR SO. 6-2 215 **PS#6**. Redshirt, 1 game '24. 12 st, 2741 (66.6. 24-6), 33 rush (0.8) last year. 12 Blake Herbert (6-2 216 rFr) PS#23. 10 Noah Grubbs (6'4" 208 Fr) PS#15. Teddy Jarrard (6'3" 190 Fr) PS#100.

RB 22 Aneyas Williams Jr. 5-10 210 **PS#16**. 15 gm, 219 (6.4), 172 rec (9.6) '24. 12 gm, 224 (9.3) LY. 21 Kedren Young (5'11" 234 So) **PS#13**. RS 7 gm, 116 (5.5)'24. OFY LY. 2 Nolan James (5'10" 215 So) RS, 4 gm, 37 (6.2) last year.

SLOT 1 JADEN GREATHOUSE JR. 6-1 215 **PS#23**. 5 st, 265 (14.7) '23. 11 st, 592 (14.1) '24. RS, 2 st, 73 (18.3) then OFY LY. 3 Mylan Graham (6'1" 192 So) **PS#13**. 9 gm, 93 (15.5) at **Ohio St** LY. 19 Logan Saldate (5'11" 185) PS#130. 4 gm LY.

WR 0 Quincy Porter rFr. 6-4 207 **PS#8**. RS, 4 gm, 49 (14.8) at **Ohio St** LY. 14 Micah Gilbert (6'2" 205 So) 10 gm, 93 (10.3) LY. 5 Cam Williams (6'2" 200 So) 4 st, 1 rec as rFr. 33 Matt Jeffery (5'11" 198 So). 89 Alex Whitman (6'2" 195 Sr).

WR 6 JORDAN FAISON SR. 5-10 185 4 st, 678 (13.8) '23-'24. 12 st, 640 (13.1) LY. 17 Elijah Burress (6'1" 190 rFr). 11 Devin Fitzgerald (6'2" 208 Fr) PS#65. 8 Jerome Bettis (6'2" 199 rFr) PS#99. 31 Xavier Southall (6'1" 180 So).

TE 87 Cooper Flanagan Jr. 6-6 250 PS#16. 7 st, 74 (14.8) '23-'24. OFY (inj) LY. 88 James Flanagan (6'6" 251 rFr) **PS#6.** 7 Ty Washington (6'4" 253 Sr) 4 st, 195 (15.0) at **Ark** '23-'24. 12 gm, 34 (6.8) LY. 85 Jack Larsen (6'3" 248 So).

C 70 ASHTON CRAIG SR. 6-5 310 **PS#73**. 3 st, 8 gm rFr. 3 st OFY (inj) '24. 6 st OFY (inj) LY. 64 **Joe Otting** (6'4" 305 Jr) **PS#54.** 7 gm rFr. 6 st, LY. 57 Cam Herron (6'2" 291 rFr) **PS#83**. LS 96 Joseph Vinci (6'4" 231 So) 20 gm L2Y.

RG 56 CHARLES JAGUSAH SO. 6-5 330 **PS#10**. 2 st, 5 gm '23-'24. OFY (inj) LY. 75 **Sullivan Abasher** (6'7" 320 So) **PS#28.** 16 gm '24. L/5 st, 12 gm LY. 52 Devan Houstan (6'4" 305 Jr) **PS#53.** 5 gm L2Y. 60 Max Anderson (6'3" 305 So). 2 gm LY.

LG 54 ANTHONIE KNAPP JR. 6-5 304 **PS#85**. 15 st '24. 12 st LY. 55 Chris Terek (6'5" 321 Jr) **PS#70**. 14 gm '24. 12 gm LY. 65 Grayson McKeogh (6'7" 298 Fr). **PS#18.** 61 Robbie Wollan (6'4" 300 So). LS 49 Andrew Kros (6'4" 227 Jr).

RT 76 GUERBY LAMBERT SO. 6-7 325 **PS#4**. RS, 6 gm '24. 12 st@RG LY. 58 Matt Augustine (6'8" 310 rFr) **PS#48.** 73 Peter Jones (6'5" 315 So) **PS#28.** Ben Nichols (6'5" 300 Fr). **PS#27.** 66 Tyler Merrill (6'6" 330 Fr) **PS#30.**

LT 74 Will Black rFr. 6'7" 316 **PS#10**. RS, 3 gm LY. 71 Styles Prescod (6'6" 298 So) **PS#44.** 9 gm rFr. 78 Owen Strebig (6'8" 302 rFr) RS, 4 gm LY. Gregory Patrick (6'5" 275 Fr) **PS#24.** 50 Sullivan Garvin (6'5" 315 Fr) PS#102.

K 35 SPENCER PORATH JR. 6-0 200 **PS#4**. 9 st. 7-11 fg. L/45, 17-17 PAT at **Pur** '24. 12 st, 15-17 fg L/53, 24-24 PAT at **Purdue** LY. Micah Drescher (6'3" 197 Fr) 50 Erik Schmidt (6'2" 211 So). **PS#1** 0-3 fg, 41-42 PAT. 70 KO/55 TB as true.

DEFENSE (Jersey # in Blue)

DE 95 Bryce Young Jr. 6-8 260 **PS#25**. 16 gm, 23 tkl, 3 tfl as true. 1 st, 20 tkl, 2 sk, 3 pbu LY. 11 Keon Keeley (6'5" 275 Jr) **PS#2**. 13 gm, 16 tkl, 3 sk at **Alabama** LY. 40 Dominik Hulak (6'3" 260 rFr) **PS#61**. 42 Cole Mullins (6'4" 280 So).

NT 47 JASON ONYE SR. 6-5 295 **PS#84**. 18 gm, 24 tkl, 2 sk '23-'24. 9 st, 26 tkl, 1.5 sk LY. 56 Elijah Hughes (6'3" 295 Sr) 14 gm, 12 tkl, 1.5 sk at **USC** '23-'24. 12 gm, 21 tkl, 3 tfl LY. 33 Chris Burgess (6'4" 275 rFr). 60 Davion Dixon (6'2" 316 rFr).

DT 0 TIONNE GRAY SO. 6-5 330 **PS#65**. 3 st, 18 tkl, 2 tfl at **Oregon** LY. 7 **Francis Brewu** (6'1" 285 Jr) 12 st, 36 tkl, 7 tfl at **Pitt** LY. 88 Armel Mukam (6'3" 296 Jr) 11 gm, 4 tkl LY. 59 Sean Sevillano (6'2" 360 rFr). 91 Gordy Sulfsted (6'5" 275 rFr).

RUSH 5 BOUBACAR TRAORE JR. 6-5 253 **PS#40**. 13 st, 48 tkl, 9.5 sk, 2 tfl L2Y. 10 Loghan Thomas (6'3" 220 Jr) **PS#44**. 26 gm, 9 tkl, 1.5 sk L2Y. 44 Rodney Dunham (6'4" 242 Fr). 94 Joe Reiff (6'5" 264 rFr). 14 Ebeneezer Ewetade (6'4" 240 Fr).

WLB 4 JAIDEN AUSBERRY JR. 6-1 228 **PS#14**. 12 st, 109 tkl, 2.5 sk, 8 tfl L2Y. 3 Jaylen Sneed (6'1" 227 Sr) 10 st, 86 tkl, 5.5 sk, 5.5 tfl L2Y. 43 Kahanu Kia (6'2" 225 Jr) PS#87. 12 gm, 9 tkl LY. 35 Teddy Rezac (6'3" 226 So) **PS#66**. 12 gm, 4 tkl LY.

MLB 34 DRAYK BOWEN SR. 6-2 235 **PS#10**. 16 st, 78 tkl, 4 tfl '24. 12 st, 67 tkl, 3.5 sk LY. 27 Kyngstonn Viliamu-Asa (6'3" 230 Jr) 3 st, 85 tkl, 4 sk, 6 tfl L2Y. 19 Madden Faraimo (6'2" 235 So) 12 gm, 16 tkl, 2 sk LY. 45 Ko'o Kia (6'2" 225 rFr).

NB 29 CHRISTIAN GRAY SR. 6-0 186 **PS#16**. 12 gm, 11 tkl, 3 pd '23. 15 st, 35 tkl, 2.5 tfl, 9 pbu, 3 int '24. 10 st, 17 tkl, 11 pbu, 2 int LY. 11 Dallas Golden (6'0" 191 So) **PS#25.** 3 st, 10 gm, 22 tkl, 2 pd LY. 32 Nick Reddish (5'10" 195 Fr). PS#110.

CB 24 MARK ZACKERY SO. 5-11 175 **PS#29**. 3 st, 10 tkl, 2 pbu LY. DJ McKinney (6'2" 180 Sr) PS#154. 1 st, 14 gm, 38 tkl, 5 pbu '23. 13 st, 62 tkl, 3 tfl, 9 pbu, 3 int '24. 9 st, 35 tkl, 6 pd LY. 26 Chaz Smith (6'1" 172 Fr) **PS#48**.

CB 15 LEONARD MOORE JR. 6-2 191 **PS#52**. 10 st, 48 tkl, 2 tfl, 11 pbu, 2 int '24. 10 st, 31 tkl, 7 pbu, 5 int **1 st tm AA.** 12 Jayden Sanders (6'0" 195 So) 2 st, 13 gm, 23 tkl LY. 21 Khary Adams (6'1" 187 Fr) **PS#7.** 13 Ayden Pouncy (6'3" 180 Fr).

SS 8 ADON SHULAR JR. 6-0 202 **PS#37**. 16 st, 59 tkl, 3 tfl, 5 pbu, 3 int. 11 st, 53 tkl, 3 tfl. 5 pbu, 2 int. 28 Luke Talich (6'4" 204 Sr) 28 gm, 45 tkl, 1 tfl, 3 pbu, 4 int last 2 yrs. 25 Brandon Logan (5'11" 197 rFr) PS#141.

FS 9 TAE JOHNSON xx. 6-1 200 **PS#29**. Redshirt, 3 gm, 3 tkl '24. 8 st, 10 gm, 48 tkl, 3 pbu, 4 int. 22 Ethan Long (5'11" 197 rFr) **PS#70**. Redshirt, 4 gm, 3 tkl as true. 20 Joey O'Brian (6'5" 203 Fr) **PS#3**. In for Spring.

P 39 Jasper Scaife SO. 6-2 215 PS#40. Australian. In for spring '26. 50 Erik Schmidt (6'2" 211 So). **PS#1** 0-3 fg, 41-42 PAT. 70 KO/55 TB as true. Micah Drescher (6'3" 197 Fr) PS#24. Originally committed to **Michigan**.

NOTRE DAME FIGHTING IRISH

South Bend, Indiana — WEATHER ZIP: 46556
Enrollment: 8,617 (#2/#124)

Phil's Homefield Edge - 5.0
2026 Schedule Difficulty - #66

DATE	OPPONENT	TURF	LINE	FINAL SCORE ND	OPP	W/L	
Sep. 6	† Wisconsin (Green Bay, Sun)	G					Shamrock Series goes to Green Bay for 3rd CFB gm ever at Lambeau. Tms played once s/'65. L/13 neutral site gms, ND 11-2 SU/10-3 ATS. Irish 3-1 ATS L/4 openers (lost at Miami LY).
Sep. 12	Rice	A					Last met '14 (Irish won, 48-17, as 21pt fav). First gm vs American other than Army Navy s/'21 (lost to Cinc, 24-13, as 2pt dog). Last 3 yrs as DD fav, Irish 16-6-1 ATS (12-6 laying 20+).
Sep. 19	Michigan State	A					First mtg s/'17 for longtime rivals (ND visits MSU in '27). Irish 4-1 L/5 but lost last home gm, 36-28, in '16. Under HC Freeman, ND 6-3 vs B1G (all 3 losses to OhioSt) but 6-1-2 ATS.
Sep. 26	at Purdue	G					Irish lead series 59-26-2 & have won 10 straight on field ('12 & '13 wins vacated). LTH '24, ND handed Purdue worst loss in history 66-7 (+416 yds). Entering '26, Irish 8-1-2 ATS L/11 vs B1G.
Oct. 3	at North Carolina (NORTH CAROLINA IS OFF BYE)	G					Irish have won 5 straight & 11 of L/12 vs Heels (4 str covers). LTH '22, ND (+2') totaled ssn high 576 yds in 45-32 win. Under HC Freeman, ND 18-3 SU & 16-5 ATS vs ACC (14-7 to over).
Oct. 10	Stanford	A					ND leads 25-14 incl 3 straight wins & 6 of L/7 (5-2 ATS). Only loss since '17 was at home in '22 as 16'pt fav. Irish (-32) won LY 49-20. Led 42-3 but allowed backdoor cover in 4Q.
Oct. 17	at BYU	G					Irish lead 7-2 incl 4 straight wins. ND (-4) won last mtg, 28-20, in '22 Shamrock Series in Vegas. First Provo trip s/'04 (Irish lost 20-17 as 5pt fav). First reg ssn gm vs Big 12 since '16.
Oct. 24							**BONUS**: ND 13-4-2 ATS last 19 vs ranked opp at home. **BONUS**: Since 2018, Irish 31-9-1 ATS in single digit spread gms (24-6 as fav/7-3-1 as dog).
Oct. 31	† Navy (Foxborough, Mass)	A					Irish lead series 82-13-1 and have won 13 of last 14 (8-6 ATS). Gillette Stadium hosting for first time. ND (-27) won LY in snowy South Bend, 49-10. Navy played w/o starting QB Horvath.
Nov. 7	Miami	A					Massive revenge spot after LY's loss at Miami kept ND out of CFP. Irish (-2') rallied from down 14 in 4Q but lost, 27-24, on fg with 1:04 left. Four of L/5 mtgs outright upsets (2 Mia/2 ND).
Nov. 14	Boston College	A					ND leads 19-9 with last loss in '08. Irish have won 4 straight at home, L/2 by 84-7 combined. ND (-30') only led 12-7 HT in LY's 25-10 win. Snapped streak of 4 straight covers by favorite.
Nov. 21	SMU	A					Irish lead 10-3 and won last 2 in '86 & '89 by 120-35 combined. Third straight yr ND facing tm from Texas (split with A&M L/2 yrs). Irish have won 9 straight on Senior Day (6-3 ATS).
Nov. 28	at Syracuse	A					ND has won 6 straight in series (5-1 ATS). LTH in '22, Irish (+1') never trailed in 41-24 win. As a road fav, ND 19-10-2 ATS since 2017. They've won 7 of the L/8 road finales (5-3 ATS).

CAREER PASSING LEADERS	CAREER RUSHING LEADERS	CAREER RECEIVING LEADERS
1. Brady Quinn 11,762 '03-'06	1. Autry Denson 4,318 '95-'98	1. Michael Floyd 3,686 '08-'11
2. Ian Book 8,948 '17-'20	2. Allen Pinkett 4,131 '82-'85	2. Golden Tate 2,707 '07-'09
3. Jimmy Clausen 8,148 '07-'09	3. Vagas Ferguson 3,472 '76-'79	3. Jeff Samardzija 2,593 '03-'06

BONUS: ND begins ssn away from home 5th straight yr, longest stretch in school history.
BONUS: Under HC Freeman, Irish 7-2-1 to the over following SU loss.

MARCUS FREEMAN

PLAYING EXP: LB at Ohio St ('04-'08), NFL: Chicago ('09), Buffalo ('09), Houston ('09)
PRIOR HC EXP: Notre Dame ('21 Bowl)
5TH Year Here / 5TH Overall

2025 RECORDS: **10-2** INDEPENDENT

2026 RET STARTERS: OFF: 7*/7* DEF: 10/9
Portal Starts: Added: 13/26 Lost: 0/5
Homegrown %: 90.7 RANK: 1/9
EXP CHART #1/#4 (CONF/OVERALL)

Straight Up	HERE/OVERALL
Record:	43-12
Bowls:	5-2
Home:	21-5
Away:	12-5
Vs Top 25:	16-8
Off Bye:	9-3
ATS	**35-18-2**
Home Fav:	13-9-1
Home Dog:	1-0-1
Away Fav:	7-5
Away Dog:	4-1
P5:	28-12-2
Non-P5:	7-6
Off SU Loss:	6-4


DL BOUBACAR TRAORE

SIGNEES 22 VHT • 7 HT • 25 IFS

Pos	Signee	Pos	Signee
TE	Ian Premer 6-6 235 PS#1	DL	Elijah Golden 6-4 270 PS#43 IFS
DB	Joey O'Brien 6-4 190 PS#3 IFS	DB	Chaz Smith 6-0 169 PS#48 IFS
DB	Khary Adams 6-1 185 PS#7 IFS	WR	Bubba Frazier 5-8 177 PS#49 IFS
DL	Rodney Dunham 6-4 225 PS#7 IFS	WR	Brayden Robinson 5-8 164 PS#57 IFS
DB	Ayden Pouncey 6-3 179 PS#14 IFS	DL	Tiki Hola 6-3 305 PS#54 IFS
RB	Javian Osborne 5-10 200 PS#10 IFS	LB	Ja'Kobe Clapper 6-2 220 PS#32 IFS
RB	Jonaz Walton 5-9 208 PS#11 IFS	TE	Preston Fryzel 6-4 220 PS#21 IFS
OL	Grayson McKeogh 6-8 300 PS#18 IFS	WR	Devin Fitzgerald 6-2 205 PS#65 IFS
WR	Kaydon Finley 6-0 212 PS#24 IFS	OL	Charlie Thom 6-7 275 PS#90 IFS
OL	Gregory Patrick 6-5 275 PS#24	DB	Nick Reddish 5-10 185 PS#110 IFS
LB	Thomas Davis 6-2 218 PS#13 IFS	OL	Sullivan Garvin 6-5 314 PS#104 IFS
DL	Ebenezer Ewetade 6-4 221 PS#33 IFS	WR	Dylan Faison 6-1 180 PS#113 IFS
OL	Ben Nichols 6-5 320 PS#27	K	Micah Drescher 6-3 198 PS#28
OL	Tyler Merrill 6-5 330 PS#30 IFS	K	Jasper Scaife 6-6 215 PS#40 IFS
QB	Noah Grubbs 6-4 208 PS#15 IFS	QB	Teddy Jarrard 6-3 190 PS#100

LAST 5 BOWLS — ALL-TIME RECORD 24-22

YR	BOWL/TEAM RANK	LINE	OPPONENT	SCORE
23	Sun - #15	-6	Oregon St - #21	40-8
24	CFP 1st Round - #3	-7	Indiana - #9	27-17
24	CFP Sugar - #3	-1	Georgia - #2	23-10
24	CFP Semifinal - #3	-1	Penn St - #5	27-24
24	CFP Championship - #3	+8'	Ohio St - #6	23-34

NOTRE DAME STADIUM - Artificial Turf
Built: 1930 • 77,622 (#16) • LY's Capacity: 100.0% (#20)

	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	10 Yr Total
STRAIGHT UP	4-8	10-3	12-1	11-2	10-2	11-2	9-4	10-3	14-2	10-2	101-29
Home	2-4	6-1	6-0	7-0	6-0	6-1	4-2	5-1	6-1	6-1	54-11
Away	0-3	3-2	4-0	3-2	4-0	4-0	2-2	3-2	3-0	4-1	30-12
Neutral	2-1	1-0	2-1	1-0	0-2	1-1	3-0	2-0	5-1	0-0	17-6
vs P5/Conf	2-7	7-3	10-1	8-2	9-1	9-1	6-3	7-3	11-1	8-2	77-24
vs Non-P5/Conf	2-1	3-0	2-0	3-0	1-1	2-1	3-1	3-0	3-1	2-0	24-5
ATS	4-8	8-5	6-6-1	9-3-1	6-6	9-4	7-6	9-3-1	12-4	7-4-1	77-49-4
Home Fav	1-4	4-3	2-3	5-2	1-4	5-1	1-4	4-1	4-3	5-1-1	32-26-1
Home Dog	1-0	0-0	1-0	0-0	1-0	0-1	1-0	0-0-1	0-0	0-0	4-1-1
Away Fav	0-1	3-2	2-1-1	2-0-1	3-1	2-1	0-0	3-2	2-0	2-3	19-11-2
Away Dog	0-2	0-0	0-0	1-0	0-0	0-0	3-1	0-0	1-0	0-0	5-3
Neutral	2-1	1-0	1-2	1-0	1-1	1-1	2-1	2-0	5-1	0-0	16-7
vs P5/Conf	2-7	6-4	6-4-1	6-3-1	4-6	8-2	6-3	7-2-1	10-2	5-4-1	60-37-4
vs Non-P5/Conf	2-1	2-1	0-2	3-0	2-0	1-2	1-3	2-1	2-2	2-0	17-12
Off SU Win	0-4	5-4	5-5-1	8-2	5-5	8-3	5-3	5-3-1	10-4	6-2-1	57-35-3
Off SU Loss	4-3	2-1	0-0	1-1	1-0	1-0	1-3	3-0	1-0	1-1	15-9

BRIAN KELLY 2010 • PLAYED IN THE ACC IN 2020* • MARCUS FREEMAN (BOWL) • MARCUS FREEMAN

OFFENSE — LAST 7 YEARS — DEFENSE

RET STS	OFF PTS	TOTAL OFF	OFF RUSH	OFF YPC	OFF PASS	PASS %	AVG PLAY	OFF YPP	SKS VS	TOTAL TURN	YEAR	RET STS	DEF PTS	TOTAL DEF	DEF RUSH	DEF YPC	DEF PASS	PASS %	AVG PLAY	DEF YPP	SKS BY
7	42.0	459	203	5.7	255	67.2	7.3	10.9	12	+13	2025	7	17.6	313	99	3.0	213	55.7	4.6	17.8	35
6*	36.1	399	201	5.7	198	66.5	6.3	11.0	25	+18	2024	9	15.5	307	138	3.8	169	52.1	4.8	19.8	40
6*	39.2	432	186	5.3	247	64.7	7.0	11.0	16	+7	2023	8	15.9	276	119	3.5	157	52.4	4.4	17.4	31
6	31.8	396	189	4.6	207	62.4	5.9	12.5	21	-3	2022	8	23.0	329	131	3.9	198	58.7	5.2	14.3	38
3	35.2	426	144	4.1	282	64.1	6.1	12.1	35	+9	2021	6	19.7	360	135	3.8	224	60.8	5.3	18.3	41
7*	33.4	449	211	5.0	237	63.8	6.2	13.4	25	+6	2020	5	19.7	344	113	3.8	231	58.0	5.6	17.5	31
7*	36.8	431	179	4.9	252	60.8	6.3	11.7	16	+17	2019	6	17.9	320	152	3.8	169	54.3	4.7	17.9	34

2025 STATISTICAL LEADERS

RUSHING	ATT	GAIN	LOST	NET	TD	AVG
Jeremiyah Love	199	1416	44	1372	18	6.9
Jadarian Price	113	701	27	674	11	6.0
Aneyas Williams	24	225	1	224	5	9.3
Kenny Minchey	7	93	9	84	1	12.0
Gi'Bran Payne	9	56	3	53	0	5.9
Nolan James	14	40	3	37	0	2.6
CJ Carr	41	146	113	33	3	0.8

PASSING	ATT	COM	PCT	YDS	TD	INT	QBR
CJ Carr	195	293	66.6	2741	24	6	168.1
Kenny Minchey	20	26	76.9	196	0	0	140.2

RECEIVING	REC	YDS	AVG	TD	LONG
Jordan Faison	49	640	13.1	4	54
Malachi Fields	36	630	17.5	5	53
Eli Raridon	32	482	15.1	0	65
Will Pauling	26	381	14.7	6	44
Jeremiyah Love	27	280	10.4	3	36
KK Smith	8	123	15.4	2	34
Micah Gilbert	9	93	10.3	1	26
Jadarian Price	6	87	14.5	2	35
Luke Talich	1	84	84.0	1	16

PUNTING	NO	YDS	AVG	FC	NET	BLK	In20
James Rendell	25	1114	44.6	12	43.3	0	13

KICKING	XP	1-29	30-39	40-49	50+	TTL	LNG
Noah Burnette	20-22	1-1	3-4	1-1	0-0	5-6	48
Erik Schmidt	41-42	0-0	0-2	0-1	0-0	0-3	0

PLAYER	TKL	SKS	TFL	PBU	INT	QBH
Drayk Bowen	67	3.5	1	4	0	2
Adon Shuler	53	1	2	5	2	2
Jaiden Ausberry	51	2	2	0	0	5
Tae Johnson	48	0	0.5	3	4	0
Kyngstonn Viliamu-Asa	48	3	4.5	2	1	5
Boubacar Traore	37	6.5	3.5	0	0	8
Jalen Stroman	37	1	2	2	1	0
Jaylen Sneed	35	3	2	0	0	3
Leonard Moore	31	0	0	7	5	0
Jason Onye	26	1.5	0	1	0	4
Luke Talich	25	0	1	3	3	0
Dallas Golden	22	0	0.5	2	1	0
Elijah Hughes	21	1	2	0	0	3
DeVonta Smith	20	0	1	3	0	0
Bryce Young	20	2	0	3	0	4
Jared Dawson	20	0.5	3	1	0	4
Jordan Botelho	20	1	0.5	0	0	2
Christian Gray	17	0	0	11	2	0
Madden Faraimo	16	2	1	1	0	1
Joshua Burnham	16	3	3	1	0	2
Gabriel Rubio	13	0.5	0	1	0	1

PUNT RETURNS	NO	YDS	AVG	TD	LNG
Jordan Faison	23	138	6.0	0	15

KICK RETURNS	NO	YDS	AVG	TD	LNG
Jadarian Price	12	450	37.5	2	100

2025 GAME-BY-GAME STATS

Weekly 2026 Stats on PhilSteele.com

ATT	OPPONENT	SCORE	OFF TTL OFF	OFF FD	OFF RUSH ATT-YDS	OFF AVG	OFF PASS CO-ATT	OFF YDS	SKS VS	DEF TTL DEF	DEF FD	DEF RUSH ATT-YDS	DEF AVG	DEF PASS CO-ATT	DEF YDS	SKS BY	NET YDS	TO'S	OFF FOE	VS DEF	DEF FOE	VS OFF	GM GRADE
66,793	at Miami, Fl	24-27	314	18	28-93	3.3	19-30	221	3	339	20	38-134	3.5	20-30	205	1	-25	-2	#10	21	#5	70	122.4
77,622	Texas A&M	40-41	429	23	39-136	3.5	20-32	293	2	488	24	32-128	4.0	17-37	360	0	-59	0	#2	132	#10	-47	114.1
77,622	Purdue	56-30	535	27	43-254	5.9	17-20	281	1	369	20	28-66	2.4	25-40	303	3	166	+1	#3	122	#8	-29	115.9
75,111	at Arkansas	56-13	641	32	40-210	5.3	24-32	431	1	365	15	30-158	5.3	17-32	207	3	276	+2	#1	235	#4	98	144.9
77,622	Boise St	28-7	389	19	31-200	6.5	15-23	189	0	315	23	34-100	2.9	22-37	215	4	74	+4	#5	55	#5	117	115.9
77,622	NC State	36-7	485	24	39-143	3.7	19-32	342	2	233	12	28-51	1.8	18-31	182	4	252	+1	#5	79	#2	171	128.8
77,622	USC	34-24	442	23	44-306	7.0	16-26	136	1	396	23	29-68	2.3	22-42	328	2	46	+2	#2	99	#6	75	123.4
44,500	at Boston College	25-10	458	22	29-159	5.5	18-26	299	0	281	21	33-12	0.4	30-45	269	5	177	+2	#6	27	#3	112	115.3
77,622	Navy	49-10	502	23	38-249	6.6	16-19	253	0	228	13	45-206	4.6	3-10	22	2	274	0	#3	142	#1	203	130.5
68,400	at Pittsburgh	37-15	387	20	36-175	4.9	21-32	212	1	219	17	25-70	2.8	19-39	149	4	168	-1	#6	61	#1	186	136.5
77,622	Syracuse	70-7	396	17	24-329	13.7	9-15	67	1	207	18	50-112	2.2	17-30	95	5	189	+3	#9	-35	#2	146	127.3
27,456	at Stanford	49-20	524	24	38-187	4.9	23-36	337	0	312	16	30-86	2.9	20-40	226	2	212	+1	#2	126	#6	-6	124.9
	TOTALS	504-211	5502	272	429-2441	5.7	217-323	3061	12	3752	222	402-1191	3.0	230-413	2561	35	1750	+13	#14	1065	#12	1097	125.0
	AVERAGES	42-18	459	23	36-203	5.7	67.2%	255	3.7%	313	19	34-99	3.0	55.7%	213	8.5%	146	+1.1	#15	89	#12	91	#5
ATTENDANCE	Power 5	43-19	461	23	36-199	5.5	66.2%	262	12	321	19	32-89	2.7	56.0%	232	29	140	+9	P4	87	P4	78	124.8
77,622 (#16)	HOME	45-18	454	22	37-231	6.3	67.1%	223	7	319	19	35-104	3.0	54.6%	215	20	135	+11	#23	85	#23	91	122.3
69,587 (#15)	AWAY	38-17	465	23	34-165	4.8	67.3%	300	5	303	18	31-92	2.9	57.0%	211	15	162	+2	#8	94	#9	92	128.8

'21 RESULTS (11-2) — PRE #9 / POST #8

RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	SCORE
#9	at Florida St OT	-7	41-38
#8	Toledo	-17	32-29
#12	Purdue	-7'	27-13
#12	† Wisconsin - #18	+6'	41-13
#9	Cincinnati - #7	+2	13-24
#14	at Virginia Tech	E	32-29
#13	USC	-7	31-16
#11	North Carolina	-3'	44-34
#8	Navy	-21	34-6
#7	at Virginia	-6'	28-3
#6	Georgia Tech	-17'	55-0
#5	at Stanford	-20	45-14

'22 RESULTS (9-4) — PRE #5 / POST #18

RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	SCORE
#5	at Ohio St - #2	+16'	10-21
#8	Marshall	-20'	21-26
–	California	-12	24-17
–	at North Carolina	+2'	45-32
–	† BYU - #16	-4	28-20
–	Stanford	-16'	14-16
–	UNLV	-26'	44-21
–	at Syracuse - #16	+1'	41-24
–	Clemson - #5	+4	35-14
#20	† Navy	-16'	35-32
#18	Boston College	-20'	44-0
#13	at USC - #5	+4'	27-38

'23 RESULTS (10-3) — PRE #13 / POST #14

RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	SCORE
#12	† Navy	-20'	42-3
#12	Tennessee St	-48'	56-3
#10	at NC State	-7	45-24
#9	Central Michigan	-34'	41-17
#9	Ohio St - #6	+3	14-17
#11	at Duke - #17	-5'	21-14
#10	at Louisville - #25	-6'	20-33
#21	USC - #10	-2'	48-20
#14	Pittsburgh	-20'	58-7
#12	at Clemson	-3'	23-31
#20	Wake Forest	-24'	45-7
#17	at Stanford	-25'	56-23

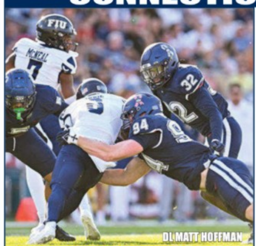
'24 RESULTS (14-2) — PRE #7 / POST #2

RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	SCORE
#7	at Texas A&M - #20	+3	23-13
#5	Northern Illinois	-28	14-16
#18	at Purdue	-7'	66-7
#17	Miami, Oh	-28'	28-3
#16	Louisville - #15	-6'	31-24
#11	Stanford	-22'	49-7
#12	† Georgia Tech	-13'	31-13
#12	† Navy - #24	-14	51-14
#10	Florida St	-25	52-3
#8	Virginia	-21'	35-14
#6	† Army - #18	-14	49-14
#5	at USC	-7'	49-35

'25 RESULTS (10-2) — PRE #6 / POST #10

RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	SCORE
#6	at Miami, Fl - #10	-2'	24-27
#8	Texas A&M - #16	-6'	40-41
#24	Purdue	-24'	56-30
#22	at Arkansas	-4'	56-13
#21	Boise St	-20'	28-7
#16	NC State	-23'	36-7
#13	USC - #20	-10	34-24
#12	at Boston College	-30'	25-10
#10	Navy	-27'	49-10
#9	at Pittsburgh - #23	-12	37-15
#9	Syracuse	-36'	70-7
#9	at Stanford	-32	49-20

CONNECTICUT HUSKIES



POSITION OUTLOOK FOR 2026

QUARTERBACKS - In '23 UConn added Joe Fagnano (2231, 57%, 15-6, Maine). Fagnano won the job, but was injured and OFY week 2. In '24 only Fagnano (173, 51%, 0-1, 32 rush) returned. They added Wisconsin transfer Nick Evers (PS#13). The two combined for 2,549 pass (56%, 25-9) with 305 rush. Rfr Tucker McDonald hit 3-5-20-0-0. Fagnano (18-4 ratio!) gained an extra year. Fagnano in his 7th season had a remarkable year throwing for 3,448 yards (69%) with an amazing 28-1 ratio (131, 2.8 rush). This year both Fagnano and Evers (10-15-105) depart. New HC Jason Candle brings in Jake Merklinger (PS#13, 13-24-173) from Tennessee and Kalieb Osborne (PS#72), who started Toledo's bowl game (32-52-427 '25) to compete with McDonald (PS#125). Candle is a solid QB developer but it will be impossible to come near Fagnano's stats.

RUNNING BACKS - UConn had not had a 1,000 yard rusher since Kevin Mensah did it in B2B years ('18-'19). In '22 true frosh Victor Rosa led with 636 (4.5). In '23 Rosa was the #1 after 6 starts but was injured finishing #2 (550, 4.9). RFr Cam Edwards moved in from S and led with 618 (5.0).In '24 Edwards got banged up and led with 830 (5.7). Mel Brown had two 100+ efforts and was #3 (673, 5.7). Last year they lost their #2 RB (3 st, 731, 6.8) but had 3 of the top 4 back. Edwards goal was 1,000 yards and he led with 1,240 (5.9). Brown broke his collarbone vs Delaware but returned week 12 vs FAU (10-70) finishing #2 (262, 8.2). Rosa was #3 (155, 5.2). This year the top 6 RB's depart. They add Kenji Christian (PS#52, 528, 5.0, Toledo), Cyncir Bowers (249, 4.0, WVirg), Trey Cornist (PS#102, 479, 5.1, CMich), Dashun Reeder (PS#130, 222, NWstern) and Jaden Hart (PS#63, 53, 3.5 Syr). Despite the talented additions, it will be tough to match Edward's production.

RECEIVERS - In '24 Skyler Bell (12 st, 444, Wisc '22) led UConn with 860 (17.2). Last year they lost their #2 (5 st, 505, 9.4) and #3 (9 st, 307, 9.6) receivers. Four of their top 6 returned. They added transfers like TE Javonte Vereen (PS#19, NCSt) and I said they should be even more productive. 6'7" 270 TE Alex Honig made the Freaks List. Bell was courted by Michigan but stayed and set UConn's record for TD rec's in a season with 13 (Carl Bond 11, '98) and rec's in a season with 102 (Noel Thomas 100 '16. He led with 1,278 (12.7). John Neider was their big play guy finishing #3 (422, 15.6). Juice Vereen was #4 (310, 14.1). This year they lose their top 4 including UConn's first ever consensus-AA Bell (#4 DC BUF). They add 11 transfers (5 from Toledo, see PSL) but no FBS starters.

OFFENSIVE LINE - In '24 the OLine lost their 3 interior starters including a #3DC. They added 3 transfers and returned 80 career starts. UConn improved to 199 rush (5.0) allowing just 14 sacks (3.5%)! Last year they lost their RT (13/39, #6 DC), 1st Tm IND LT (13/38, UFA Ariz) and RG (13/20). They returned 3 OL, who started 5+ and added PS#21 (ND) & PS#180 (MD) transfers making them deeper than you would expect with just 38 career starts. They were solid again with 161 rush (5.1) and allowed just 16 sacks (3.5%). This year 4 starters depart and they return just 24 career FBS starts. They add 10 transfers: 3 from P4, 5 from Toledo and 2 FCS starters (18 FCS car st). HC Candle likes the talented depth but they are less experienced.

DEFENSIVE LINE - In '24 the DLine had 3 starters back and the rush D, thanks to strong bowl, only allowed 132 (3.8) with 25 sacks. Last year they had to replace all 3 starters. They added 6 transfers but none had been full time starters, so this unit was my biggest concern on the team. While they improved to 37 sacks they allowed 200 (4.8) rush but did face three option teams (comb 958 rush). If you take out those 3 games, they allowed 164 ypg rush (4.3) in their other 10. This year they lose all 3 starters and 5 backups (33 st, 165 tkl, 6.5 sk) but LB's were the sack leaders last year. They add in full time starters from Ohio, Toledo and Colo St and 9 other transfers. HC Candle thinks that the overall unit is one of the best DLine he has ever had. They also go from a 3 to a 4 man front.

LINEBACKERS - Last year the unit lost all 4 starters. They added 1st Tm AAC Tyquan King (Temple), Bryum Parham, who had 106 tackles with San Jose St in '23 and returned their #11 tackler. The D slipped to allowing 54 ypg above opp avg. Their top 3 tacklers were all from this unit and highly productive. This year they lose their top 6 LB's (35 st, 15 sk, #1, #2, #8, #9 tklr). They add 5 transfers including Toledo's #1 tackler, so are almost as experienced as '25 and have one less spot to fill.

DEFENSIVE BACKS - In '24 the secondary returned 3 starters while adding 6 transfers and they had a Stock Market climb to #48 in our PDR. Last year they lost a 1st Tm Ind S but had 5 of the top 8 back. They also added 6 transfers (3 had been full time starters) but with an inexperienced front 7 fell to #86 in the PDR. This year they lose 6 DB's (47 st, 330 tkl, #3, #4, #5, #6, #7 tklr). They add in 10 transfers (five P4) but none were full time starters. While less experienced, with a more experienced front 7, they won't drop much in the PDR.

SPECIAL TEAMS - In '24 the unit upgraded by adding Indiana's K Chris Freeman (10-14) and I said they could move up in our STR. They did just that improving to #66. Freeman (miss first 3 att) hit 20-26 FG (46 TB /KO) and P Connor Stutz averaged 43.6 (38.6 net). Mel Brown averaged 29.1 on KR's. Last year Freeman made a UConn record 12 straight FG's (11 Dave Taggert 2008) and hit 22-25 (L50) while Stutz avg 44.3 (40.2 tm net). They rose to #10 in our STR. This year both depart. While the they figure to take a drop, they add an Ole Miss transfer K and a D-II P (40.2 avg), so it may not be as big of a drop as you would expect.

ST RANK LGY:	
2025	#10
2024	#66
2023	#77
2022	#122
2021	#66
2020	N/A

COACHES - Jason Candle ran the MAC's top program the last 10 years with a record of 81-44! New OC Nunzio Campanile was QB coach at Syracuse the last two years and at Rutgers prior including interim HC in 2019. DC Ryan Manalic was DC at D-II Ohio Dominican ('17-'18) and Bucknell ('19-'20) and was LB coach at Pitt ('21-'25). New STC Pat Cashmore, was STC at Wash St ('25), South Dakota St (23-'24), Pittsburg St ('20-'22) Oklahoma St ('18-'19) and Toledo ('16-'17) under HC Candle.

X @philsteele042

ALSO ON ROSTER: RB Shawn Simeon 5'10" 180 rFr RB Soren Rief 6'0" 220 rFr

2025 RECAP 9-4 - **CCSt-** UC led 25-10 H, 52-13 3Q pull strs, 59-13. **SYR-** UC 14-6 H (175-178). SY 54yd td pass 5:41, 80/10 td :48 20-17. UC 52/8 fg :01 20-20, lost ot. **DEL** 28-24 H. UC 38-35 sod 22 2:10. DE fg :00 won ot. **BALL-** UC 85/10 td 10-0 1q. BS 83/6 td 10-7 H. UC 60/14 td, BS 69/11 fg 17-10 3q. UC 24-10, 31-17. BS 65/6 td :11 31-25. **BUFF-** UB bkup qb Gray. 7-7 H. UB 57/9 td :57 17-17. UC 49/10 fg :04 20-17. **FIU-** UC score 5x poss 27-3 H, 44-3 3q (527-304). **BC** James st qb. UC 14-6, 17-13, BC 62/8 td :21 20-17 H. UC 7 sk. UC 75/6, 45/6 td 31-20 3q, 38-23. **Rice** off bye UC off upset BC. UC 80 yd td pass 7-0, 75/6 td 21-17 H RI 91/12/5:40 td 24-24 4q. UC miss 46 yd fg 4:51 Rice win 2 OT. **UAB-** UC 58/11 sod. AB 59/9 but int. UC 83/9, 67/10, 14/4 td 24-0 H (230-112). UC 38-6 3Q. AB 173-17 4q, 2 td 38-19. **Duke-** UC 20-14 H (237-143). DU td 1st 3 2H poss 28-23. UC 78/11 (fake punt fd) td. DU 80/11 td, UC 75/8 td 1:58 37-34. **AFA-** UC 40/7 td, AF 75/10 td. AF 90/19/11:50 sod 2. UC 35/7 fg 9-7 H. UC 79/6 td. AF 56/11/6:01 fg. UC 56/12 fg, 84/10 td 26-10. AF 75/9 td 26-16. **FAU-** UC 24-3, 27-17 H. FA 75/9, 99/4 td 31-27. UC 75/9, 71/7 td 41-31. FA 75/10, 76/11 td 45-41 2:11. UC 75/15 td :22 48-45.

PHIL'S FORECAST

OFFENSE - In 2024 UConn made serious strides improving to 398 ypg and 31.9 ppg their best since 2003! They set a school record with 421 yards rush vs FAU (1st time did not punt in a gm s/'04). Last year they had 6 starters back and I said they could be even stronger. My computer called for a jump to 35.2 ppg and they had 36.9 ppg! It was the first time in school history with a 3,000 yard passer (Fagnano), 1,000 yard rusher (Edwards) and 1,000 yard receiver (Bell). All 3 of them depart as does almost all the entire rooms. They have two players back who had 234 and 9 yards last year. Candle crafted great offenses at Toledo but this unit will take a step back.

DEFENSE - In '24 they hired Miss St's DC and switched to a 3-3-5. They had 8 starters back on D and I said should improve as their schedule got much easier (down 46 spots). My computer called for them to allow 371 ypg and 27 ppg and they did a little better at 347 ypg and 23 ppg. Last year they had just 4 starters back losing their entire DLine and my computer called for a slip to 25.1 ppg and they allowed 25.8!! This year the top 16 tacklers depart and while a ton of transfers come in, just one was a full time starter in the FBS.

2026 - UConn reached their peak on Jan 1, 2011 playing in the Fiesta Bowl vs Oklahoma. The next 11 years brought six coaching changes, dwindling attendance and record setting poor defenses. In 2021 UC was 7-41 the previous five years with their last 32 losses by an avg 28.5 ppg. In 2022 I said it would be an improved team but that then-HC Jim Mora was not a miracle worker. Mora was a miracle worker as the Huskies rolled to a 6-5 record with an upset of #19 Liberty to become bowl eligible for first time since 2015! They finished 6-7 and were -77 ypg. In '23 they opened 1-9 before winning the last two. If you take out their losses to three ranked teams (comb 128 pts) and their 28 pt win vs an FCS foe, they were only outscored by an avg 3.6 ppg vs their other 8 FBS foes. In '24, UConn had 14 ret strs and faced my #123 schedule. Three of my 9 sets of power ratings called for a bowl. The Huskies lost to four P4 foes (43, 5, 3 & 7 pt losses). They won their other 8 games (5-1 on 6 gm home stand)! It was their first winning season in 14 years. In the bowl they finally beat a P4 team dominating a depleted North Carolina team. Last year they had just 8 starters back but I said a double digit win season would not surprise me. UConn dominated Syracuse for 3q but lost in OT and blew a lead vs Delaware also losing in OT for a 1-2 start. After a 3rd OT loss to Rice they were just 5-3 but won the last 4 to get to 9-3 and Mora left for Colo St. This is an entirely new team and while Candle has brought in talent they will not match last years 9 win total with a completely rebuilt squad and a tougher schedule.

2026 PROJECTED STARTING LINEUP

OFFENSE (Jersey # in Blue)

QB 7 Kalieb Osborne So. 6-3 204 PS#72. 1 st, 7 gm, 427 (61.5%, 3-0) 282 rush (5.5) at Toledo LY. 4 Jake Merklinger (6'3" 215 So) **PS#13**. 4 gm, 173 (54%, 2-0) at **Tenn** LY. 12 Tucker McDonald (6'2" 225 Jr). 18 Tyler Smith (6'1" 190 rFr).
RB 3 Kenji Christian Jr. 6-2 215 PS#52. RS **V Tech** '22. 3 st, 256 (88) NCA&T '24. 3 st, 528 (5.0), 193 rec (11.4) UT LY. 23 Cyncir Bowers (5'10" 191 Sr) 2 st, **W Vir** LY. 6 Trey Cornist (5'11" 220 Jr). 24 Dashun Reeder (6'0" 190 So).
WR 2 Jediyah Willoughby So. 6-1 202 12 gm UT '24. OFY (inj) UT LY. 9 Julian Allen (6'1" 188 Jr) 7 gm, 15 (5.0) UT LY. 16 Kamren Flowers (6'0" 170 rFr) **PS#58**. RS UT LY. 25 Daniel Rose (5'10" 150 rFr). 0 Flash Wilson (5'9" 180 Sr) Inj'd '26.
WR 11 Ryder Treadway So. 6-3 193 11 gm, 176 (13.5) UT LY. 15 Cam Abshire (6'4" 185 Sr) 22 st, 1728 (19.4) D-II Emory & Henry 2Y. 1 st, 92 (9.2) **Okla St** LY. 14 Emanuel Ross (6'2" 202 So) 2 st, 110 (11.0) **Syr** rFr. 17 Teddy Williams (6'0" 180 So).
WR 8 Zy'Marion Lang Jr. 6-3 180 PS#139. 10 gm, 60 (15.0) UT '24. OFY (inj) UT LY. 5 Shamar Porter (6'3" 210 Jr. **PS#36**. 3 st, 234 (13.0) LY. 19 Javon Brown (6'5" 200 So) 13 gm, 156 (19.5) UT rFr. 85 Drew Kron (5'9" 180 Sr).
TE 86 Matt Ragan Sr. 6-5 246 PS#35. 3 gm **BC** '24. DNP **BC** LY. 83 Xavier Watson (6'4" 235 rFr). 80 Alex Godavitarne (6'4" 235 Sr) 11 gm, 255 (13.4) D-II Wheeling LY. 87 Clemens Richter (6'6" 255 So). 42 Mike Burton (6'2" 250 Sr).
C 58 Terrance Moore Sr. 6-5 305 **PS#88**. 10 st at **Pitt** '23-'24. OFY (inj) UT LY. 52 Deron McLaughlin (6'4" 270 So) 3 gm as rFr. 74 Nathan Pahanich (6'4" 291 rFr). RS **Wake Forest** LY. LS 59 David LaGanga (6'0" 212 Sr). 1 gm **KY** LY.
RG 69 TY CHAN SR. 6-5 320 **PS#21**. 12 gm at **Notre Dame** '24. 9 st, 13 gm here LY. 51 Joe McGann 6'6" 290 rFr). 62 Ben Mulholland (6'4" 315 So) 12 st Houston Christian as rFr. IFS TY. LS 24 Tashi Crofut (6'1" 227 rFr).
LG 73 Raphael Greene-Nyarko rFr. 6-6 300 PS#169. RS, 4 gm Toledo LY. 55 Fred Johnson (6'5" 295 So) 5 gm **Louisville** LY. 56 Tamarus Walker (6'3" 320 Jr) 8 gm, **Maryland** '24, 8 gm backup here LY. 59 Finn Wilkins (6'5" 315 So).
RT 79 Christian Richter SR. 6-6 300 2 st Lehigh '23. 6 gm Marshall '24. 5 st, 8 gm Marshall LY. 75 Dominic Rivera (6'8" 325 Jr) PS#143. RS **Rutgers**, OFY (inj) UT LY. 75 Hill Greenlee (6'9" 295 rFr). Owen Winder (6'8" 310 Fr) PS#163.
LT 78 Isiah Switzer rFr. 6-6 300 PS#326. RS, 1 gm Toledo LY. 67 Hannes Hammer (6'7" 313 So) PS#126. 6 gm at **Virginia Tech** L2Y. 77 Mason Howard (6'7" 285 Jr) PS#323. DNP ODU as rFr. 6 st, 20 gm at Wofford L2Y.
K 89 Mike Baker So. 5-9 185 PS#88. RS, 3 gm, 1-1 PAT, 2 KO/1TB **Ole Miss** '24. 3 gm, 5 KO/2 TB **Ole Miss** LY. Jack O'Conner (6'2" 175 Fr) PS#68. 35 Spencer Sullins (6'3" 199 So) RS **Kansas** '24. 2 gm, 2 KO/0 TB, 1 tkl here LY.

DEFENSE (Jersey # in Blue)

DE 11 Avery Dunn SR. 6-4 250 3 st, 40 tkl, 6 tfl **Mich St** '22-'23. 1 gm, OFY (inj) **Mich St** '24 11 gm, 14 tkl, 3 tfl UT LY. 17 Shamar Riser-Pressley (6'6" 271 So) 12 gm, 4 tkl Buffalo LY. 9 Zakaih Saez (6'4" 242 Jr) 5 st, 37 tkl Oreg St L2Y.
NT 3 ESEAN CARTER SR. 6-2 300 13 st, 36 tkl, 3 sk, **1st Tm MAC (PS)** Toledo LY. 14 Desmond Aladuge (6'4" 295 Jr) 11 gm, 8 tkl **Duke** L2Y. 95 Melvin Hills (6'3" 305 So) 4 gm **Texas** LY. 25 Odera Orizu (6'4" 280 Jr) RS **NCSt** '23.
DT 55 ANDREW LAURICH JR. 6-3 295 9 st, 30 tkl Colo St LY. 2 Tahjae Mullix (6'0" 290 Sr) PS#118 22 gm, 49 tkl, 4.5 tfl W Carolina '23-'24. RS Oreg St LY. 94 Matt Hoffman (6'5" 275 Sr) 4 st, 22 tkl, 2.5 tfl LY. 84 Eddie Dresch (6'3" 225 So).
Rush 15 ANUS LUQMAN SR. 6-4 260 13 st, 34 tkl, 4 sk, 5 tfl, 6 qbh Ohio LY. 52 Joshua Mickens (6'3" 250 Sr) 13 gm, 6 tkl, 1 sk **Ohio St** L2Y. 97 Chamberlain Campbell (6'6" 240 Jr) DNP **Ole Miss** as rFr. 12 gm, 6 tkl, 1 sk Toledo LY.
WLB 0 K'VON SHERMAN SR. 6-2 236 **PS#63JC**. 13 st, 93 tkl, 4.5 sk, 10 tfl, **1st tm MAC** Toledo LY. 44 John Lista (6'2" 225 Sr) 17 gm, 140 tkl, 4 sk, 7 tfl, 6 pbu Penn L2Y. Tyrique Harris (6'1" 210 Fr). 30 Charles Johnson (6'2" 205 rFr).
MLB 20 Luke Murphy Sr. 6-3 235 8 st, 94 tkl, 6 tfl E Mich '24. 37 tkl, 4 tfl C Car LY. 5 Rickey Williams (6'2" 230 So) RS **W Virg** '24. 13 gm, 13 tkl Toledo LY. 19 Ethan Hogg (6'3" 240 So) 1 st, 3 tkl as rFr. 37 Hayden Pegg (6'3" 200 So).
STAR 18 Kylish Hicks Sr. 6-1 200 13 gm, 9 tkl LY. 27 Terris Dudley (6'3" 200 So) PS#145. RS at **NC State** LY. 39 Charlie O'Connor (6'4" 215 rFr). 54 Ed Entsiwah (6'1" 240 rFr). 29 Lewenski Ydore (6'2" 220 rFr). PS#317.
LCB 6 Renick Dorilas rFr. 5-11 189 PS#94. RS at **Rutgers** LY. 8 CJ Bell (6'1" 186 rFr) RS at **Iowa** LY. 24 Zion Paret (6'0" 180 So) 3 st, 16 tkl, 1 pbu at FAU as True. 26 Shmar Akande (6'1" 186 Fr) PS#217. 28 Elijah Whitaker (6'0" 175 Fr).
BCB 7 Tyler McKinstry Jr. 5-9 182 23 gm, 9 tkl, Toledo L2Y. Moussa Kane (6'1" 195 Jr) PS#132. RS 2 gm, 1 tkl **Duke** '23. 16 gm, 20 tkl, 2 tfl, 2 int at **Duke** L2Y. Matrece Smith (6'1" 165 Fr). 38 Jaion Williams (5'10" 170 rFr).
BS 4 Braedyn Moore So. 6-2 204 PS#97. 7 gm, 2 tkl at **Wisc** as Fr. 2 st, 13 gm, 6 tkl at Toledo LY. 21 Tracy Revels (6'1" 184 Jr) 7 st, 40 tkl, 1 pbu at BG '24. DNP at **Mich St** LY. 10 Jayden Davis (6'1" 192 Sr) 11 st, 88 tkl Fresno L2Y.
FS 12 Saxton Suchanic rFr. 6-2 180 PS# 331. RS, 4 gm, 1 tkl LY. 13 Jayden Price (6'3" 205 rFr) RS, 2 gm, 1 tkl at Toledo LY. 23 Steve Miller (6'1" 185 rFr) PS#250. RS, 1 gm at **USC** LY. 33 Carter Boskovich (5'9" 185 Jr).
P 49 Tommy Warner So. 6-3 199 Australian. 12 st, 47 punts (40.2 avg), L/57, 14-I20, 38.8 net at D-II Northwest Missouri St Last year. 35 Spencer Sullins (6'3" 199 So) RS **Kansas** '24. 2 gm, 2 KO/0 TB, 1 tkl here last year.

CONNECTICUT HUSKIES

Storrs, Connecticut — WEATHER ZIP: **06118** — **Enrollment: 19,133 (#1/#78)**

Phil's Homefield Edge - 3.0
2026 Schedule Difficulty - #111

DATE	OPPONENT	TURF	LINE	FINAL SCORE UC	OPP	W/L	Notes
Sep. 5	Lafayette	G					First mtg. UConn has covered 4 str & 5 of L/6 vs FCS (beat CConnSt 59-13 LY as 28'pt fav. Lafayette was 8-4 LY, losing to BGreen (-18), 26-7. Leopards have lost 2 straight ATS vs FBS.
Sep. 12	Maryland	G					Huskies trail series 3-1. Last meeting in '24, UConn (+19) allowed ssn-high 629 yds in 50-7 road loss. After beating Indiana in '03 & '06, Huskies have lost 7 straight to Big Ten (2-5 ATS).
Sep. 19	at Southern Miss	A					First mtg. First of 3 vs SBC (JMU & ODU in Nov). Huskies only SBC win came in last mtg (beat GaSt 34-27 in '24). In only h2h mtg, HC Candle beat HC Anderson in '16, 31-10.
Sep. 26	at Miami, OH	A					First meeting. Huskies 26-10 all-time vs MAC, winning by an avg of 28-18 (incl 2 bowl wins), and 7-5 since '10 (5-7 ATS). In '25, UConn defeated Ball St & Buffalo but was 0-2 ATS.
Oct. 3	Syracuse (SYRACUSE IS OFF BYE)	G					UConn has lost 6 str to Syr incl L/2 at home in '16 & '22. L/2 mtgs decided by 7pts (Huskies covered '24 & pushed LY). UConn had lost 7 str reg ssn gms to ACC but beat BC & Duke LY.
Oct. 10	at Temple	G					Huskies trail series 14-7. Temple has covered 3 straight, 6 of L/7 & 13 of L/15! LTH in '19, UConn (+27') outgained 574-326 in 49-17 loss. S/'23, Huskies 7-3 SU/4-5-1 ATS vs American.
Oct. 17							**BONUS**: New HC Candle was 5-14 ATS as a road favorite in his final 4 yrs at Toledo. **BONUS**: Since 2014, Connecticut 12-49 SU on the road.
Oct. 23	UMass (Fri)	G					Series is tied at 38-38-2. Huskies are on a 5-2 SU run, incl 3 straight wins (2-1 ATS). Last met in '24, UConn (-10) won 47-42, but allowed the backdoor cover td with 36 sec left.
Oct. 31	at Air Force	A					UConn beat Air Force (+7') in last yr's first-ever meeting, 26-16. Huskies 2-6 SU vs MWC but have covered 5 straight. UConn has faced option 4 times since '21 (1-4 SU & 2-3 ATS).
Nov. 7	North Carolina	G					Hoops bluebloods meet for 5th time on grass. Huskies 1-3 but won last mtg, 27-14, in '24 bowl (first bowl win s/'09). S/'16, Huskies 5-15 SU vs ACC but 11-3-1 ATS L/15 (beat Duke/BC LY).
Nov. 14	James Madison	G					First time hosting JMU since '96 (Huskies lost 14-6). UConn has dropped 5 straight to Dukes incl last mtg in '23 (44-6 as 25'pt dog). Huskies 1-4 all-time vs SBC with 4 straight ATS losses.
Nov. 21	Old Dominion (OLD DOMINION IS OFF BYE)	G					First mtg. Huskies visit ODU '28. In '24, UConn (-7') beat GaSt, 34-27, to snap 4-gm losing streak to SBC (0-4 ATS L/4). S/'21, UConn 19-10-1 ATS at home (10-5-1 as fav/9-5 as dog).
Nov. 28	at Wyoming	A					First trip to Laramie and first half of home&home (Huskies host in '29). Longest road trip of '26 at 1,884 miles (UConn has won 3 straight road finales after 8 straight losses from '14-'22).
							BONUS: Since 2016, UConn 12-1-1 to the over vs ranked opponents. **BONUS**: New HC Candle was 5-0 to the over vs ranked opponents at Toledo.

CAREER PASSING LEADERS	CAREER RUSHING LEADERS	CAREER RECEIVING LEADERS
1. Dan Orlovsky 10,706 '01-'04	1. Donald Brown 3,800 '06-'08	1. Mark Didio 3,535 '88-'91
2. Matt DeGennaro 9,288 '87-'90	2. Terry Caulley 3,187 '02-'03, '05-'06	2. John Fitzsimmons 2,841 '96-'00
3. Shane Stafford 8,975 '95-'98	3. Jordan Todman 3,179 '08-'10	3. Carl Bond 2,770 '95-'98

JASON CANDLE

PLAYING EXP: WR at Geneva ('98-'99) & Mount Union ('00-'01)
PRIOR HC EXP: Toledo ('15 Bowl, '16-'25)
1ST Year Here / 11TH Overall

2025 RECORDS: **9-4** INDEPENDENT

2026 RET STARTERS: OFF: 1/1 DEF: 4/0
Portal Starts: Added: 12/56 Lost: 60/61
Homegrown %: 38.9 RANK: 2/120
EXP CHART #2/#138 (CONF/OVERALL)

Straight Up	HERE	OVERALL
Record:	0-0	81-44
Bowls:	0-0	3-5
Home:	0-0	47-11
Away:	0-0	28-27
Vs Top 25:	0-0	1-5
Off Bye:	0-0	8-11
ATS	**0-0**	**60-64-1**
Home Fav:	0-0	29-25
Home Dog:	0-0	2-2
Away Fav:	0-0	17-20
Away Dog:	0-0	8-10
Conf:	0-0	38-42-1
Non Conf:	0-0	22-22
Off SU Loss:	0-0	22-16



Pratt & Whitney Stadium at RENTSCHLER FIELD - Kentucky Bluegrass
Built: 2003 • 38,066 (#76) • LY's Capacity: 80.0% (#79)

	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	10 Yr Total
STRAIGHT UP	3-9	3-9	1-11	2-10	0-0	1-11	6-7	3-9	9-4	9-4	37-74
Home	3-4	2-4	1-5	1-5	0-0	1-5	5-1	1-5	6-1	6-0	26-30
Away	0-5	1-4	0-6	1-5	0-0	0-6	1-5	2-4	2-3	3-3	10-41
Neutral	0-0	0-1	0-0	0-0	0-0	0-0	0-1	0-0	1-0	0-0	1-2
vs Conf/ P5	1-7	2-6	0-8	0-8	0-0	0-5	1-4	0-4	1-4	2-2	7-48
vs Non-Conf/P5	2-2	1-3	1-3	2-2	0-0	1-6	5-3	3-5	8-0	7-2	30-26
ATS	3-8-1	5-7	2-10	5-7	0-0	6-6	9-4	6-6	7-5-1	6-6-1	49-59-3
Home Fav	0-3	0-2	0-1	0-1	0-0	0-1	2-0	1-1	3-2-1	4-1	10-12-1
Home Dog	1-3	2-2	1-4	3-2	0-0	3-2	3-1	2-2	0-0	1-0	16-16
Away Fav	0-0	0-0	0-0	1-0	0-0	0-1	1-0	1-0	1-1	1-4	5-6
Away Dog	2-2-1	3-2	1-5	1-4	0-0	3-2	3-2	2-3	2-1	0-0-1	17-21-2
Neutral	0-0	0-1	0-0	0-0	0-0	0-0	0-1	0-0	1-0	0-0	1-2
vs Conf/P5	3-4-1	5-3	2-6	3-5	0-0	4-1	2-3	2-2	3-2	2-1-1	26-27-2
vs Non-Conf/P5	0-4	0-4	0-4	2-2	0-0	2-5	7-1	4-4	4-3-1	4-5	23-32-1
Off SU Win	2-1	1-2	0-1	1-1	0-0	0-1	4-2	1-1	5-3	4-4-1	18-16-1
Off SU Loss	1-6-1	4-4	2-8	4-5	0-0	6-4	4-2	4-5	2-1-1	1-2	28-37-2

SIGNEES 0 VHT • 4 HT • 7 IFS

LB	Jayden Jones 210 210 PS#88 IFS	DB	Grant Blascak 6-3 205 PS#361
OL	Owen Winder 6-8 310 PS#163	DL	James Tilus 6-3 225 PS#302
WR	Zikhere Leaks 6-2 190 PS#153	DL	Mateo Kipke 6-5 240 PS#332 IFS
QB	Bo Polston 6-2 200 PS#72 IFS	WR	Logan Barnes 6-4 180 PS#351 IFS
DB	Shmar Akande 6-1 180 PS#217 IFS	DB	Martece Smith 6-1 165 PS#416
TE	Jackson Mangham 6-7 235 PS#99	DL	Rodarion Tellez 6-3 235 PS#344
LB	Tyrique Harris 6-1 210 PS#211	DL	Makijah Latiker 6-6 250 PS#389 IFS
DB	Cason Dash 6-1 185 PS#356	DB	Elijah Whitaker 6-0 175 PS#542 IFS

LAST 5 BOWLS ALL-TIME RECORD 4-5

YR BOWL/TEAM RANK	LINE	OPPONENT	SCORE
10 Fiesta - #25	+14'	Oklahoma - #9	20-48
15 St Petersburg	+4'	Marshall	10-16
22 Myrtle Beach	+12	Marshall	14-28
24 Fenway	+2'	North Carolina	27-14
25 Fenway	+8'	Army	16-41

OFFENSE — LAST 7 YEARS — DEFENSE

RET STS	OFF PTS	TOTAL OFF	OFF RUSH	OFF YPC	OFF PASS	PASS %	AVG PLAY	OFF YPP	SKS VS	TOTAL TURN	YEAR	RET STS	DEF PTS	TOTAL DEF	DEF RUSH	DEF YPC	DEF PASS	PASS %	AVG PLAY	DEF YPP	SKS BY
7*	35.3	445	161	5.1	284	68.0	6.7	12.6	16	+15	2025	4	27.0	418	200	4.7	218	65.4	5.8	15.5	37
6*	31.9	398	199	5.0	198	56.1	5.7	12.5	14	-1	2024	8	23.1	347	132	3.8	215	61.9	5.1	15.1	25
8	19.1	327	137	4.1	190	57.5	5.1	17.1	12	-4	2023	8	29.8	407	148	4.2	259	67.7	6.1	13.6	17
7	19.4	303	191	4.7	112	56.9	4.9	15.6	18	+1	2022	9	26.2	380	170	4.4	211	62.6	5.5	14.5	26
7*	15.6	265	101	3.2	164	51.0	4.1	17.0	40	-8	2021	7	38.5	452	194	4.5	258	60.8	5.9	11.7	14
5	18.9	345	129	3.6	216	59.7	5.1	18.2	33	-8	2019	9	40.5	467	224	5.9	243	63.8	7.0	11.5	19
7	22.2	376	198	4.7	179	56.9	5.3	17.0	29	-17	2018	2	50.4	617	335	7.7	282	71.6	8.8	12.2	11

2025 STATISTICAL LEADERS

RUSHING	ATT	GAIN	LOST	NET	TD	AVG
Cam Edwards	210	1272	32	1240	15	5.9
Mel Brown	32	263	1	262	2	8.2
Victor Rosa	30	161	6	155	2	5.2
Oliver Lundberg Coleman	23	138	0	138	1	6.0
Joe Fagnano	47	231	100	131	3	2.8
MJ Flowers	16	79	4	75	1	4.7

PASSING	ATT	COM	PCT	YDS	TD	INT	QBR
Joe Fagnano	285	413	69.0	3448	28	1	161.0
Nick Evers	10	15	66.7	105	1	0	147.5
Ksaan Farrar	11	18	57.9	84	0	0	100.3

RECEIVING	REC	YDS	AVG	TD	LONG
Skyler Bell	101	1278	12.7	13	80
Reymello Murphy	40	455	11.4	3	61
John Neider	27	422	15.6	2	45
Juice Vereen	22	310	14.1	5	50
Shamar Porter	**18**	**234**	**13.0**	**1**	**56**
Louis Hansen	20	194	9.7	0	19
Cam Edwards	19	187	9.8	1	34
Alex Honig	13	162	12.5	3	40
Victor Rosa	15	147	9.8	1	65
Chris Parker	5	108	21.6	0	45

PUNTING	NO	YDS	AVG	FC	NET	BLK	In20
Connor Stutz	48	2203	45.9	19	40.2(t)	0	19

KICKING	XP	1-29	30-39	40-49	50+	TTL	LNG
Chris Freeman	52-52	8-8	4-5	10-12	1-1	23-26	50

PLAYER	TKL	SKS	TFL	PBU	INT	QBH
Bryun Parham	126	10.5	5	1	1	1
Oumar Diomande	116	5	3	1	0	5
Malachi McLean	79	1	1	2	1	1
Cam Chadwick	67	1	1.5	4	4	2
Lee Molette	65	0	2.5	3	1	0
D'Mon Brinson	58	0	5.5	6	1	0
Devin Pringle	45	1	3	4	1	2
Tyquan King	42	3	0.5	2	0	2
Donovan Branch	30	3.5	1.5	1	0	7
Antoineo Harris	30	2	1	1	0	3
Vincent Carroll-Jackson	28	0	1	0	0	2
Trent Jones	28	0.5	2	6	0	4
Aaron Key	28	1	4	2	1	1
Stephon Wright	27	1	1.5	2	0	3
Tyrece Mills	25	1	1	5	0	1
Amir Renwick	24	2.5	0	0	1	1
Matt Hoffman	**22**	**0**	**2.5**	**1**	**0**	**1**
Ben Murawski	22	0	2	0	0	2
Ben Smiley	21	0	2	0	0	2
Osiris Gilbert	19	0	0.5	3	0	1

PUNT RETURNS	NO	YDS	AVG	TD	LNG
Jackson Harper	18	150	8.3	0	37

KICK RETURNS	NO	YDS	AVG	TD	LNG
Mel Brown	14	281	20.1	0	37
Terrence Smith	11	238	21.6	0	26

2025 GAME-BY-GAME STATS

Weekly 2026 Stats on PhilSteele.com

ATT	OPPONENT	SCORE	OFF TTL OFF	OFF FD	OFF RUSH ATT-YDS	OFF AVG	OFF PASS CO-ATT	OFF YDS	SKS VS	DEF TTL DEF	DEF FD	DEF RUSH ATT-YDS	DEF AVG	DEF PASS CO-ATT	DEF YDS	SKS BY	NET YDS	TO'S	OFF FOE	VS DEF	DEF FOE	VS OFF	GM GRADE
37,594	Central Conn St	59-13	638	26	33-250	7.6	27-38	388	1	257	13	40-128	3.2	9-23	129	1	381	0	#1	280	#1	135	104.3
39,391	at Syracuse	20-27	418	20	34-142	4.2	25-44	276	1	461	24	28-45	1.6	34-54	416	4	-43	+2	#7	-11	#11	-132	95.0
17,862	at Delaware	41-44	521	29	32-175	5.5	28-39	346	1	512	29	45-247	5.5	23-34	265	5	9	0	#3	125	#12	-109	92.5
25,025	Ball St	31-25	400	17	37-219	5.9	20-30	181	0	404	19	37-176	4.8	18-25	228	4	-4	+1	#7	-6	#11	-144	81.1
12,717	at Buffalo	20-17	320	17	31-165	5.3	19-32	155	1	329	17	42-204	4.9	17-29	125	0	-9	0	#9	-26	#4	35	91.9
27,310	FIU	51-10	527	22	33-150	4.5	24-34	377	3	304	18	36-130	3.6	22-36	174	5	223	+4	#1	125	#3	101	118.5
38,917	at Boston College	38-23	455	20	27-93	3.4	23-31	362	1	395	24	49-191	3.9	16-28	204	7	60	0	#7	24	#8	-13	108.8
21,122	at Rice	34-37	449	18	26-105	4.0	32-48	344	0	491	20	56-300	5.4	17-22	191	2	-42	0	#4	49	#13	-204	87.4
23,170	UAB	38-19	374	20	31-107	3.5	23-30	267	3	372	23	34-154	4.5	24-36	218	5	2	+3	#8	-54	#4	35	98.3
38,106	Duke	37-34	472	25	30-156	5.2	28-41	316	2	390	26	34-168	4.9	22-31	222	2	82	+3	#5	51	#5	36	109.6
31,457	Air Force	26-16	347	18	30-192	6.4	15-23	155	0	356	23	58-290	5.0	6-11	66	0	-9	-1	#8	-83	#4	55	95.2
16,306	at FAU	48-45	600	31	33-154	4.7	33-46	446	2	687	37	32-193	6.0	42-55	494	1	-87	+2	#1	178	#12	-264	91.4
22,461	† Army West Point	16-41	267	14	30-183	6.1	11-17	84	1	476	23	56-368	6.6	7-9	108	1	-209	+1	#11	-83	#12	-152	79.1
	TOTALS	459-351	5788	277	407-2091	5.1	308-453	3697	16	5434	296	547-2594	4.7	257-393	2840	37	354	+15	#51	291	#125	-755	96.4
	AVERAGES	35-27	445	21	31-161	5.1	68.0%	284	3.5%	418	23	42-200	4.7	65.4%	218	9.4%	27	+1.2	#53	24	#124	-63	#87
ATTENDANCE	Power 5	32-28	448	22	30-130	4.3	65.5%	318	4	415	25	37-135	3.6	63.7%	281	13	33	+5	P4	22	P4	-36	104.4
25,375 (#78)	HOME	40-20	460	21	32-179	5.5	69.9%	281	9	347	20	40-174	4.4	62.3%	173	17	113	+10	#84	7	#63	17	101.1
24,611 (#112)	AWAY	31-33	433	21	30-145	4.8	66.5%	288	7	479	25	44-221	5.0	67.5%	258	20	-46	+5	#33	49	#136	-98	94.5

'21 RESULTS (1-11) (NOT RANKED TY & PREVIOUSLY RANKED IN 2008)

PRE-RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	POST-SCORE
	at Fresno St	+27'	0-45
	Holy Cross	-3	28-38
	Purdue	+34'	0-49
	at Army West Point	+34'	21-52
	Wyoming	+31'	22-24
	at Vanderbilt	+14'	28-30
	at Massachusetts	-3	13-27
	Yale	**+3'**	**21-15**
	Middle Tennessee	+14'	13-44
	at Clemson	+41	7-44
	at UCF	+30	17-49
	Houston - #19	+32'	17-45

'22 RESULTS (6-7)

PRE-RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	POST-SCORE
–	at Utah St	+26	20-31
–	**Central Conn St**	**-20'**	**28-3**
–	Syracuse	+23'	14-48
–	at Michigan- #4	+47'	0-59
–	at NC State- #12	+38'	10-41
–	**Fresno St**	**+23**	**19-14**
–	**at FIU**	**-5'**	**33-12**
–	at Ball St	+9'	21-25
–	**Boston College**	**+7'**	**13-3**
–	**Massachusetts**	**-15'**	**27-10**
–	**Liberty- #19**	**+14**	**36-33**
–	at Army West Point	+10'	17-34

'23 RESULTS (3-9)

PRE-RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	POST-SCORE
–	NC State	+14	14-24
–	at Georgia St	+3	14-35
–	FIU	-7	17-24
–	Duke- #18	+22	7-41
–	Utah St	+4	33-34
–	**at Rice**	**+10**	**38-31**
–	USF	+1	21-24
–	at Boston College	+14'	14-21
–	at Tennessee- #19	+35	3-59
–	at James Madison- #21	+25'	6-44
–	**Sacred Heart**	**-25**	**31-3**
–	**at Massachusetts**	**-1**	**31-18**

'24 RESULTS (9-4)

PRE-RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	POST-SCORE
–	at Maryland	+19	7-50
–	**Merrimack**	**-14'**	**63-17**
–	at Duke	+16'	21-26
–	**Florida Atlantic**	**-1'**	**48-14**
–	**Buffalo**	**-6**	**47-3**
–	**Temple**	**-17**	**29-20**
–	Wake Forest	E	20-23
–	**Rice**	**-7**	**17-10**
–	**Georgia St**	**-7'**	**34-27**
–	**at UAB**	**-7'**	**31-23**
–	at Syracuse	+10'	24-31
–	**at Massachusetts**	**-10**	**47-42**

'25 RESULTS (9-4)

PRE-RANK	OPPONENT - INDEPENDENT	LINE	POST-SCORE
–	**Central Conn St**	**-28**	**59-13**
–	at Syracuse OT	+7	20-27
–	at Delaware OT	-8	41-44
–	**Ball St**	**-21**	**31-25**
–	**at Buffalo**	**-3'**	**20-17**
–	**FIU**	**-7**	**51-10**
–	**at Boston College**	**-1**	**38-23**
–	at Rice 2OT	-10'	34-37
–	**UAB**	**-11'**	**38-19**
–	**Duke**	**+8'**	**37-34**
–	**Air Force**	**-7'**	**26-16**
–	**at Florida Atlantic**	**-6'**	**48-45**

INDEPENDENT